

Q.7b (15 marks): Discuss various types of Family. Explain causes of various residence pattern of family

LevelUp IAS

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7.b) Discuss various types of Family in brief. Explain causes of various residence pattern of family. (20 marks)

As per Beils and Hoijer (1965), family is a social grouping which normally consists of two individuals of opposite sex in a union (marriage) that is recognised by society and their children.

There are various types of family based on -

1) Structure

a) Nuclear - It consists of two individuals of opposite sex (generally) and their children (Fig. 1)

b) Extended - It consists of relations beyond nuclear family (Fig. 2)

c) Joint - It is a unique type of extended family having 3 generations residing as per rules of residence (Fig. 3)

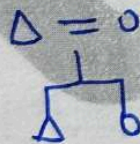


Fig. 1
Nuclear
family

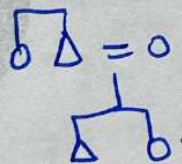


Fig. 2 Extended
family

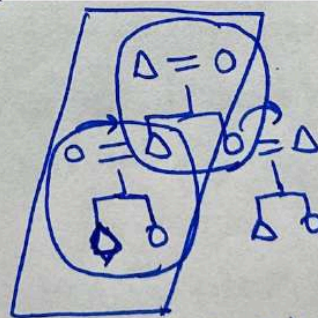


Fig. 3 Joint family

2. Authority

a) Patriarchal — In patriarchal family, the control and authority lies with the male usually eldest

b) Matriarchal — In matriarchal family, the control and authority lies with the females, usually eldest

(e.g) Khasis of Meghalaya.

c) Egalitarian — Both males and females have equal authority. (e.g) Modern urban families.

3. Nature of Blood Relations

a) Affinal — Couple related through marriage

b) Consanguineous — Couple related through blood. (e.g) Cousin-m marriages in Bedouin.

4. Descent

a) Patrilineal — The inheritance and succession passes through male line. (e.g) Tihipia of W. Pacific

b) Matrilineal — opposite of patrilineal (e.g) Nayars of Malabar

c) Bilineal — Both lines of parentage in descent (e.g) Herero of Africa

5. Residence

1) Patrilocal — The couple after marriage reside with the groom's father's family.

If they reside independently near groom's kin, it is virilocal. (e.g) Tanka studied by Woodenough

2) Matrilocal — Couple after marriage residing with bride's mother's family. (e.g) Khasis

If they reside independently near bride's kin, it is uxorilocal.

3) Aveskullocal — Couple after marriage reside with maternal uncle of bride.

(e.g) Trobrianders.

4) Bilateral — when couple keep shifting residence from patrilocal

4) Matril-patrilocal — Initially matrilocal, but later patrilocal

5) Natolocal — Both couple stay at their individual native place.

6) Nesolocal — Couple stays away from all kin.
(e.g) Modern urban families

7) Ambilocal — When no fixed rule of residence.
(e.g) British Columbians.

Relevant point

Avoid this

Causes of various residence pattern

1) Economic factors

a) Nature of food production - If prestige of profession make, then that is deciding factor. (e.g.) Hunter-gatherers usually men are patrilocal.

b) Marriage payment - In suitor service or bride service form, residence is matril-patril-local.

c) Modernisation - Due to industrialisation, families now neolocal.

2) Political factors - If men on war or voyage, females get control of family → matrilocal or if brother of females then avunculocal

3) Demographics - If sudden drop in population due to disease or other natural factors → ambilocal

(e.g.) British Columbians

Family is a basis for socialisation of children and its types have an impact on its functions.

well written answer.

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